



Receive and resolve customer complaints

D1.HRS.CL1.15

Trainer Guide



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Trainer Guide



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& hospitality

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Competency Based Training (CBT) and assessment – An introduction for trainers

Competency

Competency refers to the ability to perform particular tasks and duties to the standard of performance expected in the workplace.

Competency requires the application of specified knowledge, skills and attitudes relevant to effective participation, consistently over time and in the workplace environment.

The essential skills and knowledge are either identified separately or combined.

Knowledge identifies what a person needs to know to perform the work in an informed and effective manner.

Skills describe the application of knowledge to situations where understanding is converted into a workplace outcome.

Attitude describes the founding reasons behind the need for certain knowledge or why skills are performed in a specified manner.

Competency covers all aspects of workplace performance and involves:

- Performing individual tasks
- Managing a range of different tasks
- Responding to contingencies or breakdowns
- Dealing with the responsibilities of the workplace
- Working with others.

Unit of Competency

Like with any training qualification or program, a range of subject topics are identified that focus on the ability in a certain work area, responsibility or function.

Each manual focuses on a specific unit of competency that applies in the hospitality workplace.

In this manual a unit of competency is identified as a 'unit'.

Each unit of competency identifies a discrete workplace requirement and includes:

- Knowledge and skills that underpin competency
- Language, literacy and numeracy
- Occupational safety and health requirements.

Each unit of competency must be adhered to in training and assessment to ensure consistency of outcomes.

Element of Competency

An element of competency describes the essential outcomes within a unit of competency.

The elements of competency are the basic building blocks of the unit of competency. They describe in terms of outcomes the significant functions and tasks that make up the competency.

In this manual elements of competency are identified as an 'element'.

Performance criteria

Performance criteria indicate the standard of performance that is required to demonstrate achievement within an element of competency. The standards reflect identified industry skill needs.

Performance criteria will be made up of certain specified skills, knowledge and attitudes.

Learning

For the purpose of this manual learning incorporates two key activities:

- Training
- Assessment.

Both of these activities will be discussed in detail in this introduction.

Today training and assessment can be delivered in a variety of ways. It may be provided to participants:

- On-the-job – in the workplace
- Off-the-job – at an educational institution or dedicated training environment
- As a combination of these two options.

No longer is it necessary for learners to be absent from the workplace for long periods of time in order to obtain recognised and accredited qualifications.

Learning Approaches

This manual will identify two avenues to facilitate learning:

Competency Based Training (CBT)

This is the strategy of developing a participant's competency.

Educational institutions utilise a range of training strategies to ensure that participants are able to gain the knowledge and skills required for successful:

- Completion of the training program or qualification
- Implementation in the workplace.

The strategies selected should be chosen based on suitability and the learning styles of participants.

Competency Based Assessment (CBA)

This is the strategy of assessing competency of a participant.

Educational institutions utilise a range of assessment strategies to ensure that participants are assessed in a manner that demonstrates validity, fairness, reliability, flexibility and fairness of assessment processes.

Flexibility in Learning

It is important to note that flexibility in training and assessment strategies is required to meet the needs of participants who may have learning difficulties. The strategies used will vary, taking into account the needs of individual participants with learning difficulties. However they will be applied in a manner which does not discriminate against the participant or the participant body as a whole.

Catering for Participant Diversity

Participants have diverse backgrounds, needs and interests. When planning training and assessment activities to cater for individual differences, trainers and assessors should:

- Consider individuals' experiences, learning styles and interests
- Develop questions and activities that are aimed at different levels of ability
- Modify the expectations for some participants
- Provide opportunities for a variety of forms of participation, such as individual, pair and small group activities
- Assess participants based on individual progress and outcomes.

The diversity among participants also provides a good reason for building up a learning community in which participants support each other's learning.

Participant Centred Learning

This involves taking into account structuring training and assessment that:

- *Builds on strengths* – Training environments need to demonstrate the many positive features of local participants (such as the attribution of academic success to effort, and the social nature of achievement motivation) and of their trainers (such as a strong emphasis on subject disciplines and moral responsibility). These strengths and uniqueness of local participants and trainers should be acknowledged and treasured
- *Acknowledges prior knowledge and experience* – The learning activities should be planned with participants' prior knowledge and experience in mind
- *Understands learning objectives* – Each learning activity should have clear learning objectives and participants should be informed of them at the outset. Trainers should also be clear about the purpose of assignments and explain their significance to participants
- *Teaches for understanding* – The pedagogies chosen should aim at enabling participants to act and think flexibly with what they know
- *Teaches for independent learning* – Generic skills and reflection should be nurtured through learning activities in appropriate contexts of the curriculum. Participants should be encouraged to take responsibility for their own learning

- *Enhances motivation* – Learning is most effective when participants are motivated. Various strategies should be used to arouse the interest of participants
- *Makes effective use of resources* – A variety of teaching resources can be employed as tools for learning
- *Maximises engagement* – In conducting learning activities, it is important for the minds of participants to be actively engaged
- *Aligns assessment with learning and teaching* – Feedback and assessment should be an integral part of learning and teaching
- *Caters for learner diversity* – Trainers should be aware that participants have different characteristics and strengths and try to nurture these rather than impose a standard set of expectations.

Active Learning

The goal of nurturing independent learning in participants does not imply that they always have to work in isolation or solely in a classroom. On the contrary, the construction of knowledge in tourism and hospitality studies can often best be carried out in collaboration with others in the field. Sharing experiences, insights and views on issues of common concern, and working together to collect information through conducting investigative studies in the field (active learning) can contribute a lot to their eventual success.

Active learning has an important part to play in fostering a sense of community in the class. First, to operate successfully, a learning community requires an ethos of acceptance and a sense of trust among participants, and between them and their trainers. Trainers can help to foster acceptance and trust through encouragement and personal example, and by allowing participants to take risks as they explore and articulate their views, however immature these may appear to be. Participants also come to realise that their classmates (and their trainers) are partners in learning and solving.

Trainers can also encourage cooperative learning by designing appropriate group learning tasks, which include, for example, collecting background information, conducting small-scale surveys, or producing media presentations on certain issues and themes. Participants need to be reminded that, while they should work towards successful completion of the field tasks, developing positive peer relationships in the process is an important objective of all group work.

Competency Based Training (CBT)

Principle of Competency Based Training

Competency based training is aimed at developing the knowledge, skills and attitudes of participants, through a variety of training tools.

Training Strategies

The aims of this curriculum are to enable participants to:

- Undertake a variety of subject courses that are relevant to industry in the current environment
- Learn current industry skills, information and trends relevant to industry
- Learn through a range of practical and theoretical approaches
- Be able to identify, explore and solve issues in a productive manner

- Be able to become confident, equipped and flexible managers of the future
- Be 'job ready' and a valuable employee in the industry upon graduation of any qualification level.

To ensure participants are able to gain the knowledge and skills required to meet competency in each unit of competency in the qualification, a range of training delivery modes are used.

Types of Training

In choosing learning and teaching strategies, trainers should take into account the practical, complex and multi-disciplinary nature of the subject area, as well as their participant's prior knowledge, learning styles and abilities.

Training outcomes can be attained by utilising one or more delivery methods:

Lecture/Tutorial

This is a common method of training involving transfer of information from the trainer to the participants. It is an effective approach to introduce new concepts or information to the learners and also to build upon the existing knowledge. The listener is expected to reflect on the subject and seek clarifications on the doubts.

Demonstration

Demonstration is a very effective training method that involves a trainer showing a participant how to perform a task or activity. Through a visual demonstration, trainers may also explain reasoning behind certain actions or provide supplementary information to help facilitate understanding.

Group Discussions

Brainstorming in which all the members in a group express their ideas, views and opinions on a given topic, is a free flow and exchange of knowledge among the participants and the trainer. The discussion is carried out by the group on the basis of their own experience, perceptions and values. This will facilitate acquiring new knowledge. When everybody is expected to participate in the group discussion, even the introverted persons will also get stimulated and try to articulate their feelings.

The ideas that emerge in the discussions should be noted down and presentations are to be made by the groups. Sometimes consensus needs to be arrived at on a given topic. Group discussions are to be held under the moderation of a leader guided by the trainer. Group discussion technique triggers thinking process, encourages interactions and enhances communication skills.

Role Play

This is a common and very effective method of bringing into the classroom real life situations, which may not otherwise be possible. Participants are made to enact a particular role so as to give a real feel of the roles they may be called upon to play. This enables participants to understand the behaviour of others as well as their own emotions and feelings. The instructor must brief the role players on what is expected of them. The role player may either be given a ready-made script, which they can memorise and enact, or they may be required to develop their own scripts around a given situation. This technique is extremely useful in understanding creative selling techniques and human relations. It can be entertaining and energising and it helps the reserved and less literate to express their feelings.

Simulation Games

When trainees need to become aware of something that they have not been conscious of, simulations can be a useful mechanism. Simulation games are a method based on "here and now" experience shared by all the participants. The games focus on the participation of the trainees and their willingness to share their ideas with others. A "near real life" situation is created providing an opportunity to which they apply themselves by adopting certain behaviour. They then experience the impact of their behaviour on the situation. It is carried out to generate responses and reactions based on the real feelings of the participants, which are subsequently analysed by the trainer.

While use of simulation games can result in very effective learning, it needs considerable trainer competence to analyse the situations.

Individual /Group Exercises

Exercises are often introduced to find out how much the participant has assimilated. This method involves imparting instructions to participants on a particular subject through use of written exercises. In the group exercises, the entire class is divided into small groups, and members are asked to collaborate to arrive at a consensus or solution to a problem.

Case Study

This is a training method that enables the trainer and the participant to experience a real life situation. It may be on account of events in the past or situations in the present, in which there may be one or more problems to be solved and decisions to be taken. The basic objective of a case study is to help participants diagnose, analyse and/or solve a particular problem and to make them internalise the critical inputs delivered in the training. Questions are generally given at the end of the case study to direct the participants and to stimulate their thinking towards possible solutions. Studies may be presented in written or verbal form.

Field Visit

This involves a carefully planned visit or tour to a place of learning or interest. The idea is to give first-hand knowledge by personal observation of field situations, and to relate theory with practice. The emphasis is on observing, exploring, asking questions and understanding. The trainer should remember to brief the participants about what they should observe and about the customs and norms that need to be respected.

Group Presentation

The participants are asked to work in groups and produce the results and findings of their group work to the members of another sub-group. By this method participants get a good picture of each other's views and perceptions on the topic and they are able to compare them with their own point of view. The pooling and sharing of findings enriches the discussion and learning process.

Practice Sessions

This method is of paramount importance for skills training. Participants are provided with an opportunity to practice in a controlled situation what they have learnt. It could be real life or through a make-believe situation.

Games

This is a group process and includes those methods that involve usually fun-based activity, aimed at conveying feelings and experiences, which are everyday in nature, and applying them within the game being played. A game has set rules and regulations, and may or may not include a competitive element. After the game is played, it is essential that the participants be debriefed and their lessons and experiences consolidated by the trainer.

Research

Trainers may require learners to undertake research activities, including online research, to gather information or further understanding about a specific subject area.

Competency Based Assessment (CBA)

Principle of Competency Based Assessment

Competency based assessment is aimed at compiling a list of evidence that shows that a person is competent in a particular unit of competency.

Competencies are gained through a multitude of ways including:

- Training and development programs
- Formal education
- Life experience
- Apprenticeships
- On-the-job experience
- Self-help programs.

All of these together contribute to job competence in a person. Ultimately, assessors and participants work together, through the 'collection of evidence' in determining overall competence.

This evidence can be collected:

- Using different formats
- Using different people
- Collected over a period of time.

The assessor, who is ideally someone with considerable experience in the area being assessed, reviews the evidence and verifies the person as being competent or not.

Flexibility in Assessment

Whilst allocated assessment tools have been identified for this subject, all attempts are made to determine competency and suitable alternate assessment tools may be used, according to the requirements of the participant.

The assessment needs to be equitable for all participants, taking into account their cultural and linguistic needs.

Competency must be proven regardless of:

- Language
- Delivery Method
- Assessment Method.

Assessment Objectives

The assessment tools used for subjects are designed to determine competency against the 'elements of competency' and their associated 'performance criteria'.

The assessment tools are used to identify sufficient:

- a) Knowledge, including underpinning knowledge
- b) Skills
- c) Attitudes

Assessment tools are activities that trainees are required to undertake to prove participant competency in this subject.

All assessments must be completed satisfactorily for participants to obtain competence in this subject. There are no exceptions to this requirement, however, it is possible that in some cases several assessment items may be combined and assessed together.

Types of Assessment

Allocated Assessment Tools

There are a number of assessment tools that are used to determine competency in this subject:

- Work projects
- Written questions
- Oral questions
- Third Party Report
- Observation Checklist.

Instructions on how assessors should conduct these assessment methods are explained in the Assessment Manuals.

Alternative Assessment Tools

Whilst this subject has identified assessment tools, as indicated above, this does not restrict the assessor from using different assessment methods to measure the competency of a participant.

Evidence is simply proof that the assessor gathers to show participants can actually do what they are required to do.

Whilst there is a distinct requirement for participants to demonstrate competency, there are many and diverse sources of evidence available to the assessor.

Ongoing performance at work, as verified by a supervisor or physical evidence, can count towards assessment. Additionally, the assessor can talk to customers or work colleagues to gather evidence about performance.

A range of assessment methods to assess competency include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals: slides, audio tapes
- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects
- Role plays
- Group projects
- Group discussions
- Examinations.

Recognition of Prior Learning

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

Also known as a Skills Recognition Audit (SRA), this process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Assessing competency

As mentioned, assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency. Traditionally in education, grades or marks were given to participants, dependent on how many questions the participant successfully answered in an assessment tool.

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- Pass Competent (PC)
- Not Yet Competent (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: RECEIVE AND RESOLVE CUSTOMER COMPLAINTS		NOMINAL HOURS: 25
UNIT NUMBER: D1.HRS.CL1.15		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to receive and resolve customer complaints in a range of settings within the in the hotel industry workplace context		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Identify and analyse the complaint 1.1 Receive and accurately record a verbal <i>complaint</i> using active listening and empathy techniques 1.2 Identify through <i>appropriate communication techniques</i> the exact nature of the customer complaint 1.3 Maintain register or complaint file/s in accordance with the requirements of the enterprise information system Element 2: Respond to complaints 2.1 Process complaints in accordance with <i>organisational standards, policies and procedures</i> 2.2 Obtain and review <i>documentation</i> in relation to complaints 2.3 Update register of complaints/disputes		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment This unit applies to complaints received by the food production and food and beverage outlets within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Food Production 2. Food and Beverage Service <i>Complaint</i> may be related to: • Any expression of dissatisfaction with food and beverage products or food service by a customer and will include: • Written complaints, e.g. Letter, email, complaint and/or feedback form • Verbal, face-to-face, complaints • Verbal complaints over the telephone. <i>Appropriate communication techniques</i> may be related to: • The use of active listening

Element 3: Determine and agree upon appropriate action to resolve complaint 3.1 Identify and review <i>options</i> to resolve the complaint within enterprise policy, procedures and guidelines 3.2 Agree and confirm action to resolve the complaint with the customer 3.3 Demonstrate a commitment to the customer to resolve the complaint 3.4 <i>Inform customer of outcome</i> of investigation of complaint Element 4: Refer complaints 4.1 Identify complaints that require referral to other personnel or external bodies 4.2 Refer complaint to appropriate personnel for follow-up in accordance with individual level of responsibility 4.3 Forward all necessary documentation including investigation reports to appropriate personnel 4.4 Refer complaints which cannot be resolved to an <i>appropriate person</i>	• The use of both open and closed questions • Speaking clearly and concisely • Using appropriate language and tone of voice • Giving customers full attention • Maintaining eye contact in face-to face interactions • Appropriate non-verbal communication in face-to-face interactions, e.g. Body language, attention and personal presentation. and should include: • Conflict resolution techniques • Anger management techniques • Observation of personal safety. <i>Organisational standards, policies and procedures</i> may include: • Complaints procedures • Organisational standard report forms • Job descriptions • Code of ethics • Quality systems, standards and guidelines • Insurance/liabilities policies. <i>Documentation</i> may include: • Letters of complaint • Customer feedback forms outlining complaints, such as paper-based customer satisfaction questionnaires, internet-based customer satisfaction questionnaires • Complaint emails.
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	<i>Options</i> may include: • Options that satisfy the customer • Options that partially satisfy the customer • Options that do not satisfy the customer. and should include: • Options that reflect enterprise policy, procedures and guidelines. <i>Inform customer of outcome</i> may include: • Providing documentation and/or evidence that supports customer complaint • Providing documentation and/or evidence that does not support customer complaint. and should include: • Information (verbal or written) that directly relates to the complaint being investigated • Information (verbal or written) that is presented in a calm and accurate manner. <i>Appropriate person</i> may include: • Immediate superior within the organisational hierarchy • Specialist customer service staff • External bodies. Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Ability to apply the principles of effective communication skills • Ability to use active listening, anger management techniques and conflict resolution techniques to resolve customer complaints • Ability to identify the need(s) and concerns of a customer
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	• Ability to process a complaint in accordance with the enterprise's policies and procedures in regard to receiving and resolving customer complaints • Ability to recommend appropriate action arising from a complaint • Ability to communicate effectively with all relevant people throughout the complaint resolution process • Ability to respond appropriately to both face-to-face and written complaints • Ability to maintain all necessary workplace records and documentation. Linkages To Other Units • Communicate on the telephone • Manage and resolve conflict situations. Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Demonstrated ability to apply anger management techniques • Demonstrated ability to apply conflict resolution techniques • Demonstrated ability to use effective communication skills to accurately determine the nature of complaints • Demonstrated ability to obtain written and verbal information relevant to the complaint • Demonstrated ability to working with enterprise policies and procedures to resolve customer complaints • Demonstrated ability to initiate escalation procedures at an appropriate time within the complaint resolution process • Demonstrated ability to maintain effective communication lines with customers, other personnel and management in order to resolve customer complaints quickly.
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	Context of Assessment This unit may be assessed on or off the job: • Assessment should include practical demonstration of complaint resolution processes either in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge • Assessment must relate to the individual's work area or area of responsibility. Resource Implications Training and assessment to include access to a real or simulated workplace; and access to workplace customer service standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment and in particular those procedures, policies and guidelines that guide effective complaint resolution. Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Case studies • Observation of practical candidate performance • Oral and written questions • Portfolio evidence • Problem solving • Role plays • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work.
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	Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	2	Collect documentation and/or evidence that supports customer complaint; collect documentation and/or evidence that does not support customer complaint
	Communicating ideas and information	2	Use positive communication to encourage speedy resolution to customer complaints
	Planning and organising activities	2	Identify the most appropriate way to deal with a customer complaint
	Working with others and in teams	2	Negotiate options with customers
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	-	
	Solving problems	3	Apply conflict resolution and communication skills to resolve customer complaints
	Using technology	-	

Notes and PowerPoint slides

Slide

RECEIVE AND RESOLVE CUSTOMER COMPLAINTS

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Slide 1

Slide No	Trainer Notes
1.	Trainer introduces himself/herself, students and topic area.

Slide

Subject Elements

This unit comprises four Elements:

- Identify and analyse the complaint
- Respond to complaints
- Determine and agree upon appropriate action to resolve complaint
- Refer complaints



Slide 2

Slide No	Trainer Notes
2.	Trainer advises that this Unit comprises four Elements, as listed on the slide explaining: • Each Element comprises a number of Performance Criteria which will be identified throughout the class and explained in detail • Trainees can obtain more detail from their Trainee Manual • At times the course presents advice and information about various protocols but where their workplace requirements differ to what is presented, the workplace practices and standards, as well as policies and procedures must be observed.

Slide

Assessment

Assessment for this unit may include:

- Oral questions
- Written questions
- Work projects
- Workplace observation of practical skills
- Practical exercises
- Formal report from supervisor



Slide 3

Slide No	Trainer Notes
3.	Trainer advises that assessment for this Unit may take several forms, all of which are aimed at verifying they have achieved competency for the Unit as required. Trainer indicates the methods of assessment that will be applied to them for this Unit.

Slide



Element 1: *Identify and analyse the complaint*

Slide 4

Slide No	Trainer Notes
4.	Introduce topic. Class Activity – General Discussion Ask general questions: • What is a complaint? • What causes complaints? • What are common complaints?

Slide

Identify and analyse the complaint

Performance Criteria for this Element are:

- Receive and accurately record a verbal complaint using active listening and empathy techniques
- Identify through appropriate communication techniques the exact nature of the customer's complaint
- Maintain register or complaint file/s in accordance with the requirements of the enterprise's information system



Slide 5

Slide No	Trainer Notes
5.	Trainer identifies the Performance Criteria for this Element, as listed on the slide.

Slide

Complaints

Regardless of how well a business operates, problems will occur.

When problems occur, complaints are the common outcome that needs to be addressed:

- Who is normally the cause of problems?



Slide 6

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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6.

Activity – Discussion

- Answer the question in the slide.

Slide

Complaints

Regardless of the complaint they must be:

- Identified
- Addressed in a timely manner
- Resolved hopefully to the satisfaction of both the organisation and customer



Slide 7

Slide No	Trainer Notes
7.	Activity – Discussion • How can you identify complaints? • Who normally handles complaints in the workplace?

Slide

Complaints

Quite often complaints arise when the customer's:

- Needs
- Wishes
- Expectations

are not met!



Slide 8

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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8.

Activity – Discussion

- What is the difference between these three factors?
- Are they the same for everyone?
- Where do they come from?

Slide

Customer needs, wishes and expectations

- Common problems in relation to customer service revolve around the concepts of customer needs, wishes and expectations
- Customer service centres around an organisation's ability to meet or exceed customer needs, wishes and expectations



Slide 9

Slide No	Trainer Notes
9.	Activity – Discussion - How does an organisation try to understand a customer's needs, wishes and expectations? - How can they meet or exceed these?

Slide

Customer needs

Needs

These underlie wishes and expectations and are the things customers are unable to do without.

They may be in a foreign town and simply cannot do without:

- A bed for the night
- A meal or beverage
- A clean and hygienic environment



Slide 10

Slide No

Trainer Notes

10.

Activity – Discussion

- What are other common needs of customers in general?

Slide

Customer needs

Generic customer needs

Whilst all the organisation's customers have their own individual needs, there are a number of generic or common needs that staff must address when providing quality customer service.



Slide 11

Slide No	Trainer Notes
11.	Activity – Discussion • What are common needs of customers when visiting hotels? • What do you expect as a minimum?

Slide

Customer needs

Generic customer needs

- Value for money
- 'Offering' reflecting what was advertised
- Expectations met or exceeded
- To feel respected
- To feel welcomed
- To be served by friendly staff



Slide 12

Slide No	Trainer Notes
12.	Activity – Discussion about generic customer needs • Which hotels do you know of that provide for these customer needs? • Value for money • 'Offering' reflecting what was advertised • Expectations met or exceeded • To feel respected which is why we use "Sir" and "Madam" • To feel welcomed which is why we give all our customers a warm, genuine and sincere smile and welcome. We really are pleased to see them • To be served by friendly staff which is again why we smile and why we spend that extra few seconds with them, talking about how their day went and so on • To be dealt with in a prompt and courteous manner which is why we don't keep them waiting at reception, the bar, for room service or meals.

Slide

Customer needs

Generic customer needs

- To be dealt with in a prompt and courteous manner
- To receive assistance when necessary
- To be in comfortable, clean surroundings
- To feel remembered and recognised
- To be heard and understood



Slide 13

Slide No	Trainer Notes
13.	Activity – Discussion about generic customer needs • Which hotels do you know of that provide for these customer needs? • To be dealt with in a prompt and courteous manner which is why we don't keep them waiting at reception, the bar, for room service, meals etc. • To receive assistance when necessary which is why we have excellent product and local knowledge and why we look for opportunities to pass this on to them whenever we can, even without their having to ask • To be in comfortable, clean surroundings which is why we make sure the facilities, rooms, grounds and equipment are spotless • To feel remembered and recognised which is why we use the customer's name as often as we can • To be heard and understood which is why we listen to complaints and adopt the role of their advocate whenever there is a complaint, problem or dispute. We want to fix their problems, not create new ones.

Slide

Customer needs

Specific target market needs

Business:

- Computer and internet access
- Newspapers
- Executive lounges
- Laundry services
- Business and news channels



Slide 14

Slide No	Trainer Notes
14.	Activity – Discussion about how hotels cater to specific customer needs • What other ways can a hotel cater to the needs of this particular market segment?

Slide

Customer needs

Specific target market needs

Women:

- Hairdryers
- Larger mirrors
- Healthier food options
- Specific bathroom amenities
- Fashion magazines
- Bath



Slide 15

Slide No	Trainer Notes
15.	Activity – Discussion about how hotels cater to specific customer needs • What other ways can a hotel cater to the needs of this particular market segment?

Slide

Customer needs

Specific target market needs

Family:

- Interconnecting rooms
- All inclusive packages
- Entertainment options
- Child care facilities & Children's television programs
- Handicapped facilities &/or disabled toilets
- Safety



Slide 16

Slide No	Trainer Notes
16.	Activity – Discussion about how hotels cater to specific customer needs • What other ways can a hotel cater to the needs of this particular market segment?

Slide

Customer needs

Specific target market needs

Leisure:

- Cheaper rates
- Local attractions
- Concierge services
- Activities



Slide 17

Slide No	Trainer Notes
17.	Activity – Discussion about how hotels cater to specific customer needs • What other ways can a hotel cater to the needs of this particular market segment?

Slide

Customer needs

Specific target market needs

Elderly:

- Single beds
- Medical facilities
- Suitable food options
- Cheaper rates



Slide 18

Slide No

Trainer Notes

18.

Activity – Discussion about how hotels cater to specific customer needs

- What other ways can a hotel cater to the needs of this particular market segment?

Slide

Customer needs

Specific target market needs

Groups:

- Need for large allocation of rooms
- Cheap rates
- Meeting rooms
- Specialised menus
- Bus access and parking



Slide 19

Slide No	Trainer Notes
19.	Activity – Discussion about how hotels cater to specific customer needs • What other ways can a hotel cater to the needs of this particular market segment?

Slide

Customer wishes

Wishes

These refer to the way in which our customer would prefer to satisfy a specific need, but they may not have the resources to meet these wishes.

They may wish to:

- Stay in the luxury suite
- Dine at an internationally renowned, 5 star fine dining restaurant
- Drink expensive champagne



Slide 20

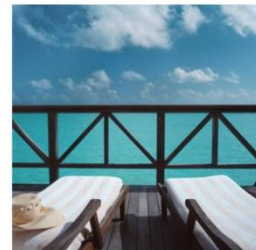
Slide No	Trainer Notes
20.	Activity – Discussion • What is the difference between a need and a wish? • Can hotels provide both?

Slide

Customer expectations

Customers have perceived expectations of what level of service they expect when visiting a venue:

- Where do expectations come from?



Slide 21

Slide No	Trainer Notes
21.	Activity – Discussion about customer expectations • Where do expectations come from?

Slide

Customer expectations

Origins of customer expectations

- The company's image or reputation in the market
- Past visits
- Advertisements and promotional messages
- Competing hotels
- Industry standards
- Comments from family, friends and colleagues
- Price charged for the offering



Slide 22

Slide No

Trainer Notes

22.

Activity – Discussion about customer expectations

- Where else do expectations come from?

Slide

Complaints

- As mentioned, complaints arise when customers' needs, wishes or expectations are not met
- Complaints are a common part of any organisation
- It is unrealistic to think that everyone will be happy, every day



Slide 23

Slide No	Trainer Notes
23.	Activity – Complaints • How should complaints be handled?

Slide

Complaints

Keys to handling complaints

Three keys to respond to customer complaints are to be:

- Positive
- Sensitive
- Polite



Slide 24

Slide No	Trainer Notes
24.	Activity – Complaints • Why should complaints be seen as a positive thing? • How can you show sensitivity?

Slide

Complaints

Types of complaints

- Rude staff and management
- Difficult or demanding customers
- Lack of service, or poor, service
- Expectations not being met
- Dissatisfaction with the accommodation
- Services are poor



Slide 25

Slide No	Trainer Notes
25.	Activity – Discuss the common types of complaints • Rude staff and management. This is a major cause of customer complaints • Difficult or demanding customers. Some customers are especially difficult to deal with and extremely demanding in their orders and the way they 'ask' for service • Lack of or poor service. This can involve the customer having to wait 'too long', the quality of products being sub-standard, staff who are disrespectful, rude or offensive when they deliver service • Expectations not being met. The advertisements that your venue runs, coupled with word-of-mouth advertising, create these expectations and they may often be unrealistic. Customers can be frustrated and disappointed when reality fails to match either the advertisements or the expectations, and conflict can often result. This classification is a common one with special needs customers • Dissatisfaction with the accommodation. For example the room facilities are not working or are out-dated, the room may smell of smoke, is too noisy or the view is not what was anticipated • Services are poor. Details may have been forgotten or the general level of service is insufficient and slow.

Slide

Complaints

Types of complaints

- Unhygienic conditions
- Low comfort levels
- Rowdy and unacceptable behaviour displayed by other customers
- A mistake with an account
- Error in the reservation or booking
- Special requests not being adhered to



Slide 26

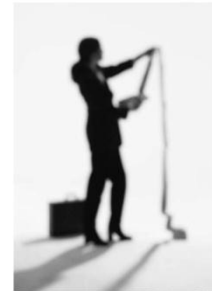
Slide No	Trainer Notes
26.	Activity – Discuss the common types of complaints ● Unhygienic conditions – perhaps where the guest room or any facility enjoyed by customers shows a lack of proper attention to detail and incorrect housekeeping practices ● Low comfort levels – an area of the property could have been too cold, too noisy, or too crowded ● Rowdy and unacceptable behaviour displayed by other customers – the room or table next to the customer may have been patronised by a noisy and boisterous customer ● A mistake with an account – the guest account may have charged for items that should have been on someone else's bill, or over-charged for a product or service ● Error in the reservation or booking or not found – the guest may have arrived to find there was a problem with a booking or reservation that they had been led to believe was guaranteed and problem-free ● Special requests not being adhered to – the flowers and champagne that were ordered for 4:00 PM were not delivered and spoiled a very special occasion.

Slide

Complaints

Types of complaints

- Limited or no rooms/tables available
- Requirement to guarantee a reservation
- Inflexibility in methods of payment
- Hidden charges
- Ejection from the premises



Slide 27

Slide No	Trainer Notes
27.	Activity – Discuss the common types of complaints • Limited or no rooms/tables available. Every business has a capacity on how many customers can be served, seated or accommodated at one time • Requirement to guarantee a reservation. Many organisations will have a guarantee policy to ensure they can maximise revenues for outlets. If inflexible conditions exist, it may irritate potential or existing customers • Inflexibility of methods of payment. A customer may wish to offer payment which the establishment may accept. Possible situations may include an organisation's refusal to take cheques or American Express payments • Hidden charges. This may include taxes or service fees the customer did not expect or was not told about • Ejection from the premises e.g. if a customer has to be removed from the premises for whatever reason.

Slide

Complaints

Warning signs of a complaint

Usually, before someone makes a complaint, they give outward signs of their dissatisfaction:

- What are possible warning signs that a customer is about to complain?
- Can all complaints be predicted?



Slide 28

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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28.

Activity – Questions

- Discuss questions in the slide.

Slide

Complaints

Warning signs of a complaint

Some signs of dissatisfaction include negative changes in:

- Body language
- Voice
- Actions



Slide 29

Slide No	Trainer Notes
29.	Activity – Questions • What changes are evident? • What should you do if a customer looks happy but has not come up to you to complain?

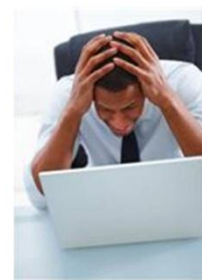
Slide

Complaints

Warning signs of a complaint

Common actions a guest may make when about to complain includes:

- Look angry or aggressive
- Appear flustered or frustrated
- Display contorted facial expressions
- Glance around as if seeking assistance
- Physically touch another guest or colleague
- Become too loud
- Become argumentative



Slide 30

Slide No

Trainer Notes

30.

Activity – Questions

- Discuss these warning signs
- As a customer what do *you* do?

Slide

Complaints

Delivery of complaints

There are a number of ways in which a complaint is brought to the attention of staff and management:

- Written complaints
- Verbal – face to face
- Verbal - telephone



Slide 31

Slide No	Trainer Notes
31.	Activity – Questions • Written complaints including by letter, email, complaint or customer feedback forms • Verbal – face to face complaints • Verbal - complaints over the telephone • Which is the most popular method and why?

Slide

Complaints

Deal with complaints sensitively, courteously and discreetly

When handling all compliant situations it is important to deal with them in a manner that is:

- Friendly
- Efficient
- Respectful
- Courteous
- Thorough



Slide 32

Slide No

Trainer Notes

32.

Activity – Discussion

- Discuss the importance of each of these points when handling complaints.

Slide

Complaints

Being sensitive

Being sensitive when dealing with a customer complaint asks you to:

- Take all complaints seriously
- Take time to assess the environment
- Factor in relevant issues
- Approach each situation appropriately
- Make requests and suggestions to people



Slide 33

Slide No	Trainer Notes
33.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss the importance of each of these points when handling complaints.

Slide

Complaints

Being courteous

Being courteous means being polite:

- Use people's name, where known
- Say 'please' when asking them to do something
- Say 'thank you' if they comply with a request
- Demonstrate respect for them
- Use open gestures



Slide 34

Slide No

Trainer Notes

34.

Activity – Discussion

- Discuss the importance of each of these points when handling complaints.

Slide

Complaints

Being discreet

Being discreet when dealing with complaints asks you to:

- Talk quietly to the person
- Remove the person to another area, if possible
- Take whatever action is appropriate to deal with the situation without drawing unnecessary attention to it



Slide 35

Slide No	Trainer Notes
35.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss the importance of each of these points when handling complaints.

Slide

Handling complaints

Handling complaints

- What, in your opinion is the best way to handle complaints?
- What would you do first?



Slide 36

Slide No	Trainer Notes
36.	Activity – Discussion to generate interest in techniques used to handle customer complaints • Discuss the questions in the slide.

Slide

Greeting the customer

Handling complaints

- Greet them
- Identify yourself
- Identify who the guest is
- Thank them for bringing the complaint to their attention



Slide 37

Slide No	Trainer Notes
37.	Activity – Discuss and Role Play • Discuss the initial customer resolution steps • Trainer may role play the scenario.

Slide

Greeting the customer

Handling complaints

- Offer assistance in trying to find a suitable solution to their complaint
- Take the person to a suitable location
- Depending on the situation, you may wish to offer them a refreshment



Slide 38

Slide No

Trainer Notes

38.

Activity – Discuss and Role Play

- Discuss the initial customer resolution steps
- Trainer may role play the scenario.

Slide

Use effective communication

Once we have greeted the customer, one of the most important aspects of handling customer complaints effectively is through the use of effective communication:

- What ways do we communicate with each other?



Slide 39

Slide No	Trainer Notes
39.	Activity – Discussion and demonstration • How do we communicate with each other? • Trainer to demonstrate different communication methods.

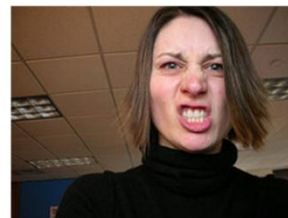
Slide

Use effective communication

Communication skills

Communication involves sending and receiving messages:

- Verbally
- Non-verbally



Slide 40

Slide No	Trainer Notes
40.	Activity – Discussion and demonstration • What are examples of each type of communication? • Which type is more evident?

Slide

Use effective communication

Communication skills – verbal

- Listening
- Questioning
- Speaking



Slide 41

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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41.	
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	Activity – Discussion
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- | | |
|--|---|
| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• What is the purpose of each of these communication methods? |
|--|---|

Slide

Use effective communication

Communication skills – non-verbal

- Facial expressions
- Eye contact
- Gestures
- Posture



Slide 42

Slide No

Trainer Notes

42.

Activity – Discussion

- Can you hide non-verbal communication?

Slide

Use effective communication

Interpersonal skills

The following skills are important for effective workplace communication:

- Face the person you are talking with
- Maintain eye contact if possible
- Address the person by their name
- Establish a rapport



Slide 43

Slide No	Trainer Notes
43.	Activity – Discussion and demonstration • Why is the use of interpersonal skills so important when handling complaints?

Slide

Verbal communication

Listening

At this time the most important thing to do is to listen so you can:

- Identify the main points of the complaint
- Separate the actual aspects of the complaint from the emotion
- Identify a possible suggested solution
- *The customer must be given the time to say their piece!*



Slide 44

Slide No

Trainer Notes

44.

Activity – Discussion

- What is the difference between hearing and listening?
- Why should you not interrupt someone?

Slide

Verbal communication

Questioning

Asking questions also enables you to:

- Acquire more accurate information
- Identify what the other person wants in order to solve the complaint
- Demonstrate you are actively and genuinely interested in resolving the complaint
- Clarify ambiguities
- Better understand contexts



Slide 45

Slide No	Trainer Notes
45.	Activity – Discussion • What types of questions can you ask?

Slide

Verbal communication

Types of questions

Closed questions:

- Asking closed questions clarifies or confirms information
- Simple 'Yes' or 'No' answer

Open questions:

- Asking open questions is often used to gain more information



Slide 46

Slide No

Trainer Notes

46.

Activity – Discussion

- Trainer asks the trainees to provide some examples of closed and open questions.

Slide

Verbal communication

Questioning techniques

Useful techniques when questioning people to obtain information about a complaint or to determine a possible solution are to:

- Rephrase or repeat questions
- Paraphrase the responses they have given you



Slide 47

Slide No	Trainer Notes
47.	Activity – Discussion • Why is this important?

Slide

Non verbal communication

Observing customer's body language

When we listen and question, we are also:

- Watching to identify non-verbal communication
- Analysing what the person is saying
- Interpreting the words and the body language



Slide 48

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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48.

Activity – Discussion

- What is this important?

Slide

Non verbal communication

Transmitting body language

You need to pay attention to the messages your body language is sending when dealing with a conflict situation:

- Your stance and posture
- Your facial expressions
- How you hold your arms



Slide 49

Slide No	Trainer Notes
49.	Activity – Discussion • Why is this important?

Slide

Recording complaint details

Write information

When the customer is talking, it is important that you write the information down as it:

- Helps identify the actual aspects of the complaint
- Shows you have taken the complaint seriously



Slide 50

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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50.

Activity – Discussion

- Discuss the importance of writing information down.

Slide

Recording complaint details

Repeat information

Once the customer has finished explaining their complaint, it is worthwhile to repeat back the complaint to the customer.

This allows you to establish:

- The scope and nature of the problem
- Any history that might accompany it



Slide 51

Slide No	Trainer Notes
51.	Activity – Discussion • Why is this important?

Slide

Recording complaint details

Repeat information

Repeating information is important as it:

- Shows that you have indeed been listening
- States the complaint, without the emotion – normally making the complaint less serious
- Ensures the complaint is correct
- Acts as a basis to work towards a solution



Slide 52

Slide No	Trainer Notes
52.	Activity – Discussion • Why is it important to take out the 'emotion' and to identify just the facts?

Slide

Speaking

- Now that we have listened and asked questions to identify the aspects of the complaint it is now time to work towards finding an acceptable solution
- It is now our time to speak and to start the process towards reaching a solution to the complaint



Slide 53

Slide No	Trainer Notes
53.	Activity – Discussion • What should the focus of your discussion be on?

Slide

Speaking

The effectiveness of our communication will be influenced by various elements of our speech.

These elements are:

- Pitch or tone
- Intensity
- Projection
- The pauses we use in our speech



Slide 54

Slide No

Trainer Notes

54.

Activity – Discussion

- What should the focus on your discussion be on?

Slide

Speaking

Stay calm and positive

A positive and cooperative manner can help to:

- Smooth over a potentially problematic situation
- Demonstrate your willingness to resolve the issue
- Create an initial friendly atmosphere
- Maintain positive customer relations



Slide 55

Slide No	Trainer Notes
55.	Activity – Discussion • How else can you keep this delicate situation positive?

Slide

Speaking

Apologise for problem and inconvenience

One of the first things that we communicate in our response is to acknowledge that a complaint exists:

- Thank the customer for bringing the complaint to them
- Acknowledge that a problem has occurred
- Acknowledge the inconvenience
- Apologise for it



Slide 56

Slide No	Trainer Notes
56.	Activity – Discussion • Why is this important? • Do you always need to apologise?

Slide

Clarify details of the complaint

Defining the complaint

An essential factor in resolving complaints is that:

- The nature and details of the conflict are identified
- Accepted by everyone as being at the heart of the issue



Slide 57

Slide No	Trainer Notes
57.	Activity – Discussion • How can you define the nature and details of the complaint?

Slide

Clarify details of the complaint

Defining the complaint

- Names of those involved
- Details of times, dates, figures, amounts
- Identification of exact service or products that failed
- The factual details
- Actions or inactions taken (or not taken) by staff or other people



Slide 58

Slide No

Trainer Notes

58.

Activity – Discussion

- Is there any other information you would like to know?

Slide

Agree on details of the complaint

Agree on the nature and details of the complaint

- Repeat back to the person what they have told you
- Elicit additional information and clarification
- Obtain assurance that what they have told you constitutes the entire complaint
- Confirm they are genuinely seeking a solution to what has been described



Slide 59

Slide No	Trainer Notes
59.	Activity – Discussion • Why is it important to agree on the nature of the complaint?

Slide

Handling alcohol related complaints

Whilst most complaints are not influenced by alcohol, it is important to handle these situations, when they arise, in a professional manner:

- Why is handling complaints involving alcohol different?
- How do you handle these situations?



Slide 60

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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60.

Activity – Discussion

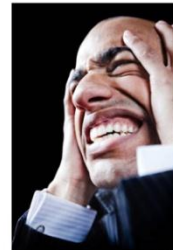
- Discuss questions in the slide.

Slide

Handling alcohol related complaints

Tips for handling alcohol related complaints

- Identify situations where problems may arise as early as possible
- Try to involve the customer by providing options
- Treat the customer professionally
- Don't touch the customer, where possible
- Take action as early as possible
- Follow all house policies, rules and regulations



Slide 61

Slide No	Trainer Notes
61.	Activity – Discussion • What else can help when trying to negotiate with a drunk person?

Slide

Keeping written documentation

Whenever a complaint is received it is common policy for many hospitality establishments to keep a written record of it:

- What are the benefits of keeping a written record of information?



Slide 62

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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62.

Activity – Discussion

- Outline the benefits.

Slide

Keeping written documentation

Benefits of written documentation

- Establishes a clear record of facts relating to a complaint
- Identifies any communication or action taken place to date
- Keeps facts of a complaint accurate and impartial
- Is helpful for additional internal and external parties who may later become involved in the complaint resolution process



Slide 63

Slide No	Trainer Notes
63.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss these benefits.

Slide

Keeping written documentation

Benefits of written documentation

- Can be used as a reference for similar complaints in the future
- Acts as an evidence source if additional costs are incurred
- Acts as a tool to identify common problems which are to be investigated
- Generates a pool of 'guest preferences' which can be used in the future to avoid further complaints



Slide 64

Slide No	Trainer Notes
64.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss these benefits.

Slide

Keeping written documentation

Complete any necessary documentation accurately

Regardless of the documentation to be used, all information recorded should be completed:

- Accurately and honestly
- Clearly
- Comprehensively



Slide 65

Slide No	Trainer Notes
65.	Activity – Discussion • What forms or records are used when recording complaint information? • Who keeps this information?

Slide

Keeping written documentation

Complete any necessary documentation accurately

It is imperative that all staff have an understanding of:

- The internal forms and reports that need to be completed
- The mandatory registers that need to be completed
- When to complete forms, reports or registers
- Who is allowed to complete them
- The time within which they must be completed



Slide 66

Slide No	Trainer Notes
66.	Activity – Discussion • Does a written record need to be completed for each and every complaint? • Why/why not?

Slide



Element 2:

Respond to complaints

Slide 67

Slide No	Trainer Notes
67.	Introduce topic. Class Activity – General Discussion Ask general questions: Once you have received a complaint and have agreed on its nature, what is the next step?

Slide

Respond to complaints

Performance Criteria for this Element are:

- Process complaints in accordance with organisational standards, policies and procedures
- Obtain and review documentation in relation to complaints
- Maintain register of complaints/disputes



Slide 68

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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68.	Trainer identifies the Performance Criteria for this Element, as listed on the slide.
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Slide

Processing complaints

Once complaints have been received, agreed and documented it is now time to:

- Process the complaint
- Hopefully find a solution
- That is of benefit to both the customer and the organisation



Slide 69

Slide No	Trainer Notes
69.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss the importance of these points • What considerations are there that will impact on how a solution is made?

Slide

Processing complaints considerations

Organisational standards, policies and procedures

When processing complaints they must be done in compliance with organisational:

- Standards
- Policies
- Procedures



Slide 70

Slide No	Trainer Notes
70.	Activity – Discussion and Provide examples • What is the difference between standards, policies and procedures? • Trainer to show examples of organisational standards, policies and procedures?

Slide

Processing complaints considerations

Code of ethics

A code of ethics, also referred to as a code of conduct, outlines how it will handle various issues including customer complaints:

- What is included in a 'Code of Ethics'?



Slide 71

Slide No	Trainer Notes
71.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss possible topics that are included in a 'Code of Ethics'.

Slide

Processing complaints considerations

Code of ethics

The code of ethics may focus on ensuring:

- Complaints can be submitted easily
- All complaints are taken seriously
- Timely responses are given in a prompt and polite manner



Slide 72

Slide No	Trainer Notes
72.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss how to ensure these topics can be measured or maintained?

Slide

Processing complaints considerations

Code of ethics

The code of ethics may focus on ensuring:

- All action will be communicated in a timely manner
- Complaints will be investigated and where possible, learnt from
- All complaints will remain confidential or to protect the privacy of parties



Slide 73

Slide No	Trainer Notes
73.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss how to ensure these topics can be measured or maintained?

Slide

Processing complaints considerations

Quality systems, standards and guidelines

Each organisation will have an accepted level of performance that must be obtained in handling customer complaints.

These may include stated:

- Objectives
- Rules
- Guidelines



Slide 74

Slide No	Trainer Notes
74.	Activity – Discussion • What are examples of 'an accepted level of performance'? • Is this possible to measure? • Where is this information held? • How do staff know about these standards?

Slide

Processing complaints considerations

Scope of authority

All staff are under a legal obligation to only act within their specifically assigned scope of authority, relating to:

- Their ability to act on behalf of the venue
- Their authority to spend money on behalf of the venue
- Their authority to act in given situations



Slide 75

Slide No	Trainer Notes
75.	Activity – Discussion • What are examples of complaints which can be managed by: a) Staff themselves? b) Supervisors? c) Senior Management? For each of these positions what is included in their 'scope of authority' when handling complaints and taking action?

Slide

Processing complaints considerations

Complaints procedures

All organisations will have set procedures that must be followed in the event that a customer complaint has been submitted:

- What will these procedures identify?



Slide 76

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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76.

Activity – Discussion

- Discuss question in the slide.

Slide

Processing complaints considerations

Complaints procedures

- How complaints can be lodged
- Who can handle the complaints
- Timelines for handling complaints
- Timelines and documents to be completed
- Reporting process
- Level of authority
- Steps to follow if complaint process or decision is not satisfactory



Slide 77

Slide No	Trainer Notes
77.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss the different procedural inclusions.

Slide

Processing complaints considerations

Third party documents

Where external parties will be required to handle aspects of a complaint, they will have their own policies and procedures that must be addressed and followed:

- Police
- Medical/hospitals
- Insurance companies
- Embassies and consulates
- Airlines, car hire and other transportation providers



Slide 78

Slide No

Trainer Notes

78.

Activity – Discussion

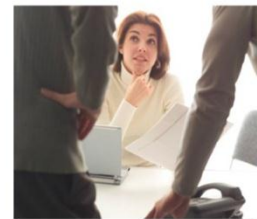
- When are these external parties involved?
- What types of information or documentation will they require?

Slide

Review documents/evidence

One of the key requirements of any investigatory activity in relation to a customer complaint is to collect evidence of problems that have lead to the complaint itself:

- Why is it important to collect and review evidence?



Slide 79

Slide No	Trainer Notes
79.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss question in the slide.

Slide

Review documents/evidence

Purpose of collecting evidence

Helps to identify:

- Truth behind a complaint
- Extent of the complaint
- Cause of the problem
- Who is responsible
- Level of liability
- Areas for improvement in the future



Slide 80

Slide No

Trainer Notes

80.

Activity – Discussion

- How can you collect evidence?
- What are you looking for when collecting evidence?

Slide

Review documents/evidence

Identify sources of problems

- Where complaints take place, there must be a reason why a specific problem has taken place
- We need to identify the source of problems



Slide 81

Slide No	Trainer Notes
81.	Activity – Discussion • What are the common sources of problems which lead to complaints?

Slide

Review documents/evidence

Identify sources of problems

Source of problems are normally caused by:

- Employee
- Organisation
- Customer



Slide 82

Slide No

Trainer Notes

82.

Activity – Discussion

- What are the common problems or reasons for complaints stemming from each of these sources?

Slide

Review documents/evidence

Identify sources of problems

Employee qualities:

- Problems may stem from the employee themselves and can include:
 - Person is new to the role
 - Person does not understand what they need to do
 - Person does not have the knowledge and skills to do the task



Slide 83

Slide No	Trainer Notes
83.	Activity – Discussion • How can these causes or problems be reduced?

Slide

Review documents/evidence

Identify sources of problems

Employee qualities:

- Person may have personal problems
- Person cannot handle stressful situations
- Physical problems, such as lack of energy, restricted movement, pain or illness



Slide 84

Slide No

Trainer Notes

84.

Activity – Discussion

- How can these causes or problems be reduced?

Slide

Review documents/evidence

Identify sources of problems

Organisational sources:

- Limited training
- Lack of supervision, direction, instruction or explanation by management
- Ineffective rostering of staff
- Bad physical work environment and unsafe conditions
- Ineffective work processes
- Faulty equipment or power cuts



Slide 85

Slide No	Trainer Notes
85.	Activity – Discussion • How can these causes or problems be reduced?

Slide

Review documents/evidence

Identify sources of problems

Customer sources

At times, the complaint may be influenced by the customer themselves including:

- Large amount of customers coming at the same time
- Difficult customers
- Unreasonable requests



Slide 86

Slide No	Trainer Notes
86.	Activity – Discussion • How can these causes or problems be reduced? • What do we do if we find out the customer himself/herself is the cause of the problem?

Slide

Collect documents/evidence

Collecting evidence relating to the complaint

This evidence may come in the form of:

- Invoices
- Discussions with staff
- Discussions with other customers
- Reviewing of surveillance equipment
- Cashiering discrepancy reports
- Observations
- Findings from external investigations



Slide 87

Slide No	Trainer Notes
87.	Activity – Discussion • How can you access this evidence?

Slide

Update register of complaints

During the evidence collection process, any new information should be updated in the complaint file:

- Why is this important?
- What information should be recorded?



Slide 88

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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88.

Activity – Discussion

- Discuss questions in the slide.

Slide

Update register of complaints

Information to contain in file

- Details of the person making complaint
- Details of the complaint
- Chronological order of events
- Summary of discussions or activities taken
- Record of person's involved
- Evidence collected
- Recommendations



Slide 89

Slide No	Trainer Notes
89.	Activity – Discussion • Why is this information important? • Where should these files or information be kept?

Slide



Element 3:
***Determine and agree
upon appropriate
action to resolve
complaint***

Slide 90

Slide No	Trainer Notes
90.	Introduce topic. Class Activity – General Discussion Ask general questions: Once you have received a complaint and have agreed on its nature, what is the next step?

Slide

Determine and agree upon appropriate action to resolve complaint

Performance Criteria for this Element are:

- Identify and review options to resolve procedures and guidelines
- Agree and confirm action to resolve the complaint with the customer
- Demonstrate a commitment to the customer to resolve the complaint
- Inform customer of outcome of investigation of complaint



Slide 91

Slide No	Trainer Notes
91.	Trainer identifies the Performance Criteria for this Element, as listed on the slide.

Slide

Identify and review options to resolve the complaint

- Now is the time to discuss and identify a possible solution to the problem
- Most complaints can be effectively resolved by more than one solution



Slide 92

Slide No

Trainer Notes

92.

Activity – Discussion

- How can you identify a range of solutions to complaints?

Slide

Identify and review options to resolve the complaint

Your aim must be to find a resolution that is:

- Quick, easy and practical to implement
- Satisfies those involved
- Meets the limitations imposed on you by the law and organisational requirements.
- Satisfies both customer and organisation



Slide 93

Slide No	Trainer Notes
93.	Activity – Discussion What needs to be taken into consideration?

Slide

Determining possible solutions

Possible options

- What the customer wants
- Taking into account all points of view
- Organisational policies
- Pre-programmed decisions
- Non-programmed decisions



Slide 94

Slide No

Trainer Notes

94.

Activity – Discussion

- Why is it important to consider these points when identifying options?

Slide

Determining possible solutions

What the customer wants

- One easy way to find out how to resolve the complaint is to encouraging the customer to identify what will solve the issue
- Quite often all they may seek is an apology or a resolution is easier than what the manager was expecting



Slide 95

Slide No	Trainer Notes
95.	Activity – Discussion • Why is this the easiest method? • How do you ask the customer? • What do you say if there ideas are not realistic?

Slide

Determining possible solutions

Taking into account all points of view

- When dealing with a customer complaint it is important to consider the points of view of all parties involved



Slide 96

Slide No	Trainer Notes
96.	Activity – Discussion - Why is this important? - How should this be approached and managed?

Slide

Determining possible solutions

Organisation policies

Formal, written policies on dealing with customer complaints are useful because they:

- Provide guidance on what to do in order to resolve situations
- Give consistency when dealing with customers
- Relieve staff from having to make decisions



Slide 97

Slide No	Trainer Notes
97.	Activity – Discussion • Who prepares these policies? • Where are they normally located? • How are staff made aware of them?

Slide

Determining possible solutions

Organisation policies

These policies may address issues such as:

- Who should deal with problems, complaints at different levels
- When management or security staff should be involved
- The limits of scopes of authority
- Situations under which the property will not try to resolve a conflict regardless of what the customer may allege
- Documentation for completion
- Staff training required



Slide 98

Slide No

Trainer Notes

98.

Activity – Discussion and Review or create policies

- What is the benefit of having policies?
- Trainer to show audience some policies that are used in the workplace OR get the audience to create some policies they would implement.

Slide

Determining possible solutions

Pre-programmed decisions

- Pre-programmed decisions are where a set policy or procedure is used to resolve an identified complaint
- Many establishments use pre-programmed decisions to assist with complaint resolution
- A pre-programmed decision is a decision that has been thought about and put in place to act as a standard establishment response to a given set of circumstances



Slide 99

Slide No	Trainer Notes
99.	Activity – Discussion For what common complaints would pre-programmed decisions be established?

Slide

Determining possible solutions

Pre-programmed decisions

- Designed for common problems
- Provide consistency in decisions made
- Saves staff having to determine what action they should take



Slide 100

Slide No	Trainer Notes
100.	Activity –Review or create pre-programmed decisions • Trainer to show audience some policies that are used in the workplace OR get the audience to create their own.

Slide

Determining possible solutions

Non-programmed decisions

Non-programmed decisions are where specific responses to individual complaints are determined on an individual case by case basis:

- What should be the process in these scenarios?



Slide 101

Slide No	Trainer Notes
101.	Activity –Review or create pre-programmed decisions Discuss question in the slide.

Slide

Determining possible solutions

Non-programmed decisions

If there is no pre-programmed action to follow then the manager has four basic options to choose from:

- Ask the person what it will take to fix the problem
- Meet the customer half-way or part-way
- Offer a formal apology
- Do nothing



Slide 102

Slide No	Trainer Notes
102.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss the possible solution techniques.

Slide

Agree on solution

- Once all possible solutions have been placed on the table for consideration, there needs to be a concerted effort to find a mutually agreed solution



Slide 103

Slide No	Trainer Notes
103.	Activity – Discussion - After discussing options, how can you reach an agreement? - What processes or techniques would you use?

Slide

Agree on solution

Constraints when reaching solution

- Costs and budgets
- Written policies
- Availability
- Organisational constraints
- Legal constraints



Slide 104

Slide No

Trainer Notes

104.

Activity – Discussion

- Why is it important to consider these constraints?
- What constraints exist?

Slide

Agree on solution

Define agreed solution

In many cases a written course of action will be documented that outlines what action is to take place to resolve the complaint, as agreed by both parties:

- Why is it important to document an agreed solution?
- What information would you wish to record?



Slide 105

Slide No	Trainer Notes
105.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss questions in the slide.

Slide

Agree on solution

Define agreed solution

This may include a record and commitment outlining:

- Actions or activities to take place
- Who is responsible for ensuring action takes place
- Who will undertake action
- Timelines
- Agreed standard of actions



Slide 106

Slide No	Trainer Notes
106.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss points.

Slide

Resolve the complaint

Demonstrate a commitment to resolve the complaint

- Now that agreement has been reached it must be actioned
- This should be done as soon as possible and must be exactly in accordance with the agreement that had been reached



Slide 107

Slide No	Trainer Notes
107.	Activity – Discussion • How can you demonstrate a commitment to resolve the complaint? • What action would you take?

Slide

Resolve the complaint

Demonstrate a commitment to resolve the complaint

Complaint resolution activities can be done by:

- Manager or staff member themselves
- Delegated to another person



Slide 108

Slide No

Trainer Notes

108.

Activity – Discussion

- If activities are delegated to another person for their follow up what should the manager do?

Slide

Resolve the complaint

Delegated resolution to another person

The manager or staff member must:

- Explain the complaint to the correct individual
- Ensure it is being completed within the specified time frame
- Keep the customer informed of the progress of the resolution
- Ensure the complaint has been resolved in accordance with the agreement and to the customer's satisfaction



Slide 109

Slide No	Trainer Notes
109.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss the importance of these points.

Slide

Resolve the complaint

Inform customer of outcome of investigation of complaint

- Inform customer of outcome
- Keep customer informed
- Follow up with customer



Slide 110

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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110.	
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	Activity – Discussion
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- | | |
|--|---|
| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Discuss the importance of these points. |
|--|---|

Slide

Investigate complaint

Reasons for undertaking investigatory activities are to:

- Identify problem
- Ascertain the causes of the problem
- Seek remedies to reduce it



Slide 111

Slide No	Trainer Notes
111.	Activity – Discussion • Do all complaints need thorough investigation? • What ways can you investigate complaints?

Slide

Investigate complaint

Some complaints that may NOT require investigation include:

- Human error
- Cultural or language misunderstanding
- Communication error
- Problem with machinery
- Simple procedural error
- Uncontrollable event
- Something out of the control of the organization



Slide 112

Slide No

Trainer Notes

112.

Activity – Discussion about complaints not requiring investigation

- Human error – a bed sheet was dirty or meal undercooked
- Cultural or language misunderstanding – customer with limited local language ability misunderstood menu item
- Communication error - someone forgot to pass on a message
- Problem with machinery – television in room didn't work or internet didn't connect
- Simple procedural error – there was a delay in getting room service to a room
- Uncontrollable event – everyone checked-out at the same time causing delays
- Something out of the control of the organization, like a power cut or internet was slow.

Slide

Investigate complaint

Some complaints requiring investigation include:

- Those occurring on a regular basis
- Those of a serious nature
- Those which can be improved
- Those which can be solved through training



Slide 113

Slide No	Trainer Notes
113.	Activity – Discussion about complaints requiring investigation • Occur on a regular basis – delays in check-in or check-out • Are of a serious nature – such as food poisoning, sexual harassment or death • Can be improved – furniture and furnishings are out-dated • Can be solved through training.

Slide



Element 4: *Refer complaints*

Slide 114

Slide No	Trainer Notes
114.	Introduce topic. Class Activity – General Discussion Ask general questions: • When would you refer a complaint? • How is this decided? • Who are complaints referred to? • What is your role once a complaint has been referred to someone else?

Slide

Refer complaints

Performance Criteria for this Element are:

- Identify complaints that require referral to other personnel or external bodies
- Refer complaint to appropriate personnel for follow-up in accordance with individual level of responsibility
- Forward all necessary documentation including investigation reports to appropriate personnel
- Refer escalated complaints which cannot be resolved to an appropriate person



Slide 115

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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115.	Trainer identifies the Performance Criteria for this Element, as listed on the slide.
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Slide

Identify complaints for referral

Whilst most complaints can be handled by individual staff members or managers within their scope of authority, at times complaints may need to be referred to executive management or external bodies:

- What complaints are commonly referred?



Slide 116

Slide No

Trainer Notes

116.

Activity – Discussion

- Discuss question in the slide.

Slide

Identify complaints for referral

Common complaints for referral

This normally relates to matters:

- Of a serious nature
- Where specialist skills, knowledge and equipment is needed to determine evidence
- Where criminal activity has taken place
- Where scope of authority is exceeded



Slide 117

Slide No	Trainer Notes
117.	Activity – Discussion about common complaints for referral • Of a serious nature – such as death, assault, theft etc. • Where specialist skills, knowledge and equipment is needed to determine evidence such as financial statements and records from banks or security surveillance equipment • Where criminal activity has taken place • Where scope of authority is exceeded.

Slide

Refer complaint to appropriate person

When it has been determined that a complaint needs to be referred to another person it must be done so in a timely manner:

- Who is the appropriate person?



Slide 118

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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118.

Activity – Discussion

- Who are complaints normally referred to and why?

Slide

Refer complaint to appropriate person

Appropriate internal persons

The appropriate person, in some situations, may be:

- A co-worker who has more experience than you
- Higher manager
- Security



Slide 119

Slide No	Trainer Notes
119.	Activity – Discussion • Who else could you refer the matter to within the company?

Slide

Refer complaint to appropriate person

Appropriate internal persons when handling intoxicated patrons

- It must be remembered, that the health and safety of staff and customers is the primary objective when handling complaints, especially instances involving intoxication
- As a staff member, it is not a requirement for you to place yourself in harm's way if you feel you cannot handle the situation



Slide 120

Slide No	Trainer Notes
120.	Activity – Discussion ● If an intoxicated customer gets out of control, who can you contact?

Slide

Refer complaint to appropriate person

Appropriate internal persons when handling intoxicated patrons

- Supervisor/Management
- Security
- DJ



Slide 121

Slide No	Trainer Notes
121.	Activity – Discussion • Supervisor/Management – they will make or authorise courses of action to take • Security – they will have the expertise to deal with the matter • DJ – they have the capacity to communicate not only with different authorities but can also communicate directly to the patrons within the venue.

Slide

Refer complaint to appropriate person

Appropriate external persons

- Police
- Fire
- Ambulance
- Security company



Slide 122

Slide No	Trainer Notes
122.	Activity – Discussion • Police – in the event of any activity that is breaking the law or likely to increase the risk of harm to all patrons and staff • Fire – if there appears to be a likelihood of fire • Ambulance – in the event a person requires medical assistance.

Slide

Refer complaint to appropriate person

Reaching suitable external assistance

Easy to reach contact details can include:

- Special button
- Posters with contact numbers
- Speed dials
- Other methods that are suitable



Slide 123

Slide No	Trainer Notes
123.	Activity – Discussion • Why is it important to have easy to reach numbers? • What is the best way to contact external people in emergency situations?

Slide

Forward documentation

Forward all necessary documentation including investigation reports to appropriate personnel

- By having accurate and completed records and evidence, it helps them to gain an understanding of all aspects of the matter in a more effective manner



Slide 124

Slide No

Trainer Notes

124.

Activity – Discussion

- What else can you do to help ensure the person responsible for resolving the complaint has all the information they need?

Slide

Forward documentation

Follow up with appropriate personnel

- Whilst handing of written documentation and evidence is a great way to provide assistance to those to whom responsibility has been given for undertaking further activity, it is also worthwhile to meet with them personally to conduct a handover



Slide 125

Slide No	Trainer Notes
125.	Activity – Discussion • What would be discussed in a handover?

Slide

Forward documentation

Follow up with appropriate personnel

Benefits of conducting a personal handover include:

- Background information can be summarised
- Key points can be highlighted
- A first hand account of activities can be explained, including reasoning for specific actions
- Sensitive or confidential information can be identified and explained
- Any queries can be clarified
- Any further information or questions that others may have can be answered



Slide 126

Slide No	Trainer Notes
126.	Activity – Discussion • What would be discussed in a handover?

Slide

An escalated complaint

Types of escalated complains

- The organisational policies specifically call for the complaint to be handled by management or some other nominated person
- Every genuine effort on your part to resolve the issue has been unsuccessful
- Physical confrontation is likely
- Customer is swearing, making threats or drawing substantial attention to themselves



Slide 127

Slide No	Trainer Notes
127.	Activity – Discussion • What do you do in these escalated situations? • Who should handle these situations?

Slide

An escalated complaint

Types of escalated complains

- The customer is alleging impropriety, dishonesty or other fraudulent activity on behalf of a staff member
- Customer intends taking legal action
- Customer intends referring the complaint to the authorities
- Customer intends taking the issue to the media



Slide 128

Slide No

Trainer Notes

128.

Activity – Discussion

- What do you do in these escalated situations?
- Who should handle these situations?

Slide

Summary

Whilst customer complaints are often seen in a negative light, they can be an opportunity to turn an unfortunate situation into a positive learning experience.



Slide 129

Slide No	Trainer Notes
129.	Activity – Discussion • Discuss the importance of why a customer complaining can be seen as a positive interaction.

Slide

Revision and Assessments

It is now time to complete any:

- Revision
- Activities
- Assessments



Slide 130

Slide No

Trainer Notes

130.

Class Activity – Revision and Assessments

- Explain Revision and Assessments
- Trainer to give trainees time to undertake Revision and Assessments.

Slide



***Finish:
Thank you!***

Slide 131

Slide No	Trainer Notes
131.	This is the conclusion of the subject • Thank the trainees and deliver assessments as required.

Recommended training equipment

- Code of Ethics
- Communication documents used in workplace
- Complain forms
- Complain register, file or folio
- Computer with internet and email access
- Customer complain surveys
- Examples of complaint evidence including Invoices, discussions with staff, and other customers, surveillance equipment, cashiering discrepancy reports, findings from external investigations
- Job descriptions
- Note pads and pens
- Organisational standards, policies and procedures
- Procedures for handling alcohol related complaints
- Procedures for handling complaints
- Scopes of authority when handling complaints
- Standard Operating Procedures (SOP's)
- Third Party Documents – police, fire, insurance forms.

Instructions for Trainers for using PowerPoint – Presenter View

Connect your laptop or computer to your projector equipment as per manufacturers' instructions.

In PowerPoint, on the **Slide Show** menu, click **Set up Show**.

Under Multiple monitors, select the Show Presenter View check box.

In the **Display slide show** on list, click the monitor you want the slide show presentation to appear on.

Source: <http://office.microsoft.com>

Note:

In Presenter View:

You see your notes and have full control of the presentation

Your trainees only see the slide projected on to the screen

More Information

You can obtain more information on how to use PowerPoint from the Microsoft Online Help Centre, available at:

<http://office.microsoft.com/training/training.aspx?AssetID=RC011298761033>

Note Regarding Currency of URLs

Please note that where references have been made to URLs in these training resources trainers will need to verify that the resource or document referred to is still current on the internet. Trainers should endeavour, where possible, to source similar alternative examples of material where it is found that either the website or the document in question is no longer available online.

Appendix – ASEAN acronyms

AADCP	ASEAN – Australia Development Cooperation Program.
ACCSTP	ASEAN Common Competency Standards for Tourism Professionals.
AEC	ASEAN Economic Community.
AMS	ASEAN Member States.
ASEAN	Association of Southeast Asian Nations.
ASEC	ASEAN Secretariat.
ATM	ASEAN Tourism Ministers.
ATPMC	ASEAN Tourism Professionals Monitoring Committee.
ATPRS	ASEAN Tourism Professional Registration System.
ATFTMD	ASEAN Task Force on Tourism Manpower Development.
CATC	Common ASEAN Tourism Curriculum.
MRA	Mutual Recognition Arrangement.
MTCO	Mekong Tourism Coordinating office.
NTO	National Tourism Organisation.
NTPB	National Tourism Professional Board.
RQFSRS	Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System.
TPCB	Tourism Professional Certification Board.

